

Bruno Fernandes

Bruno Fernandes could not have asked for a better lead-up to the World Cup. With eight goals and a record-equalling 20 assists, Fernandes has arguably been the best player in the Premier League this season.

He has been central to Manchester United's turnaround, from being 14th after seven games to securing a Champions League spot. He is the only player to hit double figures in expected assists in the league this season (12.17), creating 32 big chances, 13 more than the next best.

His instinctive pings, and his hunger to win loose balls without breaking stride, make him the gold standard for any midfielder at the tournament in North America. Additionally, United's lack of European football and early cup exits this season ensure that the 31-year-old enters the tournament with plenty of gas left in the tank.

With 28 goals (and 26 assists) in 87 appearances, Bruno will travel to the World Cup as Portugal's second-highest active scorer behind Cristiano Ronaldo (143).

But, used to being the main man at his club, it remains to be seen how much liberty Fernandes will be given by Portugal manager Roberto Martinez. With 41-year-old Cristiano Ronaldo likely to be the team's focal point — a role Fernandes thrives in — Portugal fans will hope a consensus can be reached where he can express his chaotic genius and win his first major international trophy.

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Age - 31

Club - Manchester United

NT Appearances - 87

Goals - 28

Assists - 26